

BOYS REGIONAL FINAL



ROSS WEITZNER / CHRONICLE PHOTOS

Olmsted Falls had another loud cheering section Saturday in Toledo, but this time the Bulldogs' fans went home unhappy after a loss.

Fall seniors leaving strong legacy

Gansey, Binggeli and Scales fall short of goals, but build winning program

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

TOLEDO — The Gansey Era ended abruptly Saturday night after seven good seasons.

In a memorable shooting display, Toledo St. John's routed Olmsted Falls 79-62 at the University of Toledo, ending the Bulldogs' tournament run and Steve Gansey's stellar high school career.

Gansey and the 'Dogs bowed out before a crowd estimated at 6,700 in a Division I regional final in Savage Hall. Their season ended 22-3 after winning the Southwestern Conference, sectional and district tournament championships.

St. John's, which won the Toledo regional last year, heads for a Final Four matchup with Columbus Brookhaven at 6 p.m. Friday at Value City Arena on the Ohio State campus. Brookhaven's Saturday night victory over Cincinnati Moeller was a rematch of last year's Division I state title game.

The Titans will take fond memories of a 75-percent field-goal shooting display with them — and of a second half in which they missed only one shot from the floor.

When Falls coach Pat Donahue greets next year's varsity squad, he will be minus a Gansey for the first time since Steve Gansey's older brother Mike showed up in shorts and sneakers in the fall of 1997.

Not only will Steve Gansey's graduation give the 2004-05 Bulldogs a different look, they also lose three other senior starters — Dan Binggeli, Jamar Scales and Mickey Mental.

"I'm proud of the seniors, and I'm proud of this entire team," said Donahue. "This is a bunch of classy young men. But obviously Steve and Dan have a special place in my heart. They've been involved in our



Olmsted Falls saw too much of Brian Roberts (22), who scored 25 points for the Titans.

program since fourth grade, so you're looking at eight years I've been around them.

"Obviously I'm going to miss them. I've only been around Jamar for two years, but I'm going to miss him a lot also. He brought a lot of special things to us. We're just going to have to see what happens from

here."

Donahue also said he was startled to learn that St. John's had missed only one shot in the second half.

The Bulldogs were impressed by the Titans.

"Toledo St. John's is a great team," Gansey said. "They came after us right from the start. We set a goal at

the beginning of the year that we wanted to make it to the Final Four. We came up short. But I'm proud of my team, coaches and everyone."

Scales said the Titans guards made a difference in the outcome.

"We couldn't pressure their guards like we wanted to, especially (Brian Roberts)," said Scales. "We needed to pick that up, but by the time we did, it was too late."

"We didn't come out very strong and we didn't have a very good first half," Binggeli said. "They came out better than us in the beginning. I mean, they're a great team and I wish them the best of luck."

Falls fans flock to cheer

Some 1,400 Olmsted Falls fans made the trip to Toledo, about 400 more than attended Thursday night's semifinal win over Mansfield Senior.

Many of them made the trip in five buses — three charters and two school buses.

School officials tried to charter more, but they were booked for other weekend activities, Todd Bowers said.

Number issues

Bulldogs point guard Mickey Mental again had to wear No. 50 on his home white jersey, even though he's listed in the program as No. 10. Why? The Bulldogs' home whites don't have a 10. Their blue and gold shirts do.

College stars

How talented are St. John's Titans? Roberts, a senior, has committed to the University of Dayton; Zach Hillesland, a junior, has already committed to Notre Dame, and B.J. Raymond, their 6-foot-6 post, is sitting through some 40 collegiate possibilities. And he's only a junior.

Loud atmosphere

Saturday night's crowd was the second 6,000-plus turnout of the day for Savage Hall. Slightly more than 6,000 showed up for the Division II afternoon game that saw Ottawa-Glandorf nip Akron St. Vincent-St. Mary.

Ottawa-Glandorf handed St. John's one of its four regular-season losses.

FALLS

From D1

crowd of 6,700 at the University of Toledo's John F. Savage Hall.

The Titans (22-4) shot 75 percent from the floor and missed only one shot in the second half, hitting 15 of 16. For the game they sank 33 of 44 shots, had 44 points in the paint and made 5-of-8 from behind the 3-point arc.

St. John's standouts Brian Roberts and B.J. Raymond each scored 25 points.

"I don't remember them missing," said Donahue, speaking of the second half. "We allowed Raymond to get into a rhythm and once he did that, there was nothing we could do. Roberts did a great job creating his shots. We tried to change things up. In the second half we used a defense we haven't used all year — a 1-2-2 half-court trap.

"But you're grasping for straws when a team shoots like that."

"Our confidence level was high," said Raymond, a 6-foot-6 junior. "After the first couple went in, you can see the shots going in in your head."

Raymond hit 11-for-11 from the floor and Roberts, who is going to the University of Dayton, made 10 of his 15 attempts.

But hot shooting was just part of the story.

"They flat out beat us up," Donahue said. "I've heard they play great defense when they want to and they wanted to tonight. They were in our face and forced us into low percentage shots. That was a very good basketball team out there tonight."

Gansey had 16 points, Binggeli 14 and Scales 11, but they shot just 14-of-35 from the floor. The Bulldogs made eight 3-pointers, but took 23 of them.

Furthermore, Falls got very little offense by way of its press. Although the Bulldogs scored 24 points off turnovers, they did their damage mostly in the last 3:42 of the third quarter when Roberts and 6-7 Zach Hillesland, who had 13 points, went to the bench with three fouls apiece.

At that point, Olmsted Falls made a tremendous effort to get back into the game.

Scales scored on a rebound and then Gansey made a four-point play, sinking an off-balance 3-pointer and a free throw. Corey Sparks put in two baskets and Pat Braddick made a 3-pointer at the buzzer to cap a 13-1 run and slice a 52-37 deficit to 56-50 with one quarter left.

"Then they came out strong in the fourth quarter and hit big shots," Binggeli said.

"I was on the bench (in the third quarter), but I knew we weren't going to lose," said Roberts. "We refused to lose."

In a bit more than two minutes the Titans ran off 11 points, started by a three by Raymond, and pushed the lead back to 15. Game set and match.

St. John's made all seven of its shots in the third quarter after going 8-for-9 in the third, a 93.8 percent for one half. In the first 16 minutes the Titans sank 64.3 percent.

"We were shooting too many jump shots, but they were going in," said St. John's coach Ed Heintschel. "We've had good-shooting games. We shot well."

Heintschel wasn't pleased with the way his Titans finished Thursday's game against Cleveland Rhodes. It was a better team on Saturday.

"We knew what we had to do," said Hillesland. "We've been in this situation before."

The Titans knew they had to handle the Bulldogs' pressure and get heat on Falls' shooters.

"After we saw them play Mansfield, the press was our greatest concern," said Heintschel. "And we didn't want Gansey to get good looks. We wanted to wear him out. Zach did a nice job face-guarding him and B.J. did a good job on Scales."

Gansey didn't score in the fourth quarter.

"Olmsted Falls is a very good team and they play hard," Heintschel said. "But we had a good night shooting and that made it tough on them."

St. John's advances to the state tournament for the second straight year, facing Columbus Brookhaven on Friday at 6 p.m. in the state semifinals.

Falls finishes with a 22-3 record.

TOLEDO ST. JOHN (79) Duane Keller 4-1-9 Ted Heintschel 1-0-2 Brian Roberts 10-3-25 Zach Hillesland 5-3-13 B.J. Raymond 11-0-25 Mike Floyd 1-0-2 Mickey Desady 1-0-2 Mike Schen 0-1-1 Jonathan Dunn 0-0-0 Andrew Taylor 0-0-0 Joe Jankowski 0-0-0 Sean Patterso 0-0-0 Ira Brown 0-0-0 Totals 33-8-79

OLMSTED FALLS (62) Dan Binggeli 4-3-14 Pat Braddick 4-0-10 Jamar Scales 5-0-11 Steve Gansey 5-3-16 Mickey Mental 2-0-5 Jack Samlapp 1-0-2 Corey Sparks 0-0-0 Clayton Lawrence 0-0-0 Eric Arcum 0-0-0 Corey Sparks 2-0-4 Greg Rietz 0-0-0 Adam Rockhold 0-0-0 Jason Tabor 0-0-0 Tyler Sparks 0-0-0 Totals 23-8-62

St. John's 20 18 18 23 — 79
Olmsted Falls 12 15 23 12 — 62

Field goals: Olmsted Falls 23-57 (40.4 percent), St. John's 33-44 (75 percent) Free throws: Olmsted Falls 8-11 (72.7 percent), St. John's 8-16 (50 percent) Three pointers: Olmsted Falls 8-23 (34.3 percent), St. John's 2-8 (25 percent) Rebounds: Olmsted Falls 25 (Scales 6) St. John's 25 (Raymond 9) Turnovers: Olmsted Falls 16, St. John's 16 Personal fouls: Olmsted Falls 14 St. John's 19 Fouled out: None

SOMETIMES THE ANSWERS CAN'T BE FOUND IN THE BACK OF A BOOK.

AS A PARENT, one of your greatest dreams is to see that your children achieve theirs.

As school counselors, we are trained to help your children reach their full potential. There is a common misconception that the only role of the school counselor is to help students get into college.

But there are countless situations we can help them get out of. Every day, students face challenges. Tough courses, peer pressure, eating disorders, depression, school violence.

It's a long list. And even the best parents with the best intentions don't always know what's on their children's minds. Often, children are more willing to open up to someone who doesn't have the power

to ground them or to grade them. Someone who exists purely to guide them.

It's been said that life is a journey, so make sure your kids have a guide. A collaborative relationship with your children's school counselor can reinforce that they are heading in the right direction.

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A LEARNING ACTIVITY FOR PARENTS AND CHILDREN

fraction funnies

One of the skills your child learns in school is working with fractions. You can use the comic strips from today's Chronicle to introduce or reinforce this skill. Many strips are created in fractional parts. Check out the comics section to see how the funnies can help you teach your child fractions. Write the name of the strips on the lines below. Try to find at least two strips that show:

Whole _____

Halves _____

Thirds _____

Fourths _____

Just for fun, mix up some of the comics. For example, paste on a separate piece of paper the first frame of one comic with the second frame of another. See if you can piece together a strip that makes sense.

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Newspaper Association of America Foundation
1921 Gallows Road, Suite 600, Vienna, VA 22182-3900
703-902-1600 Fax 703-902-1736

FINAL FOUR

Top seed falls

The Associated Press

Ms. Basketball Mel Thomas of Cincinnati Mount Notre Dame was named Most Valuable Player of the Division I tournament after leading a 59-44 upset of No. 1 Dayton Chaminade-Julienne in the state title game Saturday night.

Thomas had 21 points, five assists and made 5 of 8 shots from 3-point range for the second-ranked Cougars, who ended their season with a 28-0 record.

Her teammate, Lee Stephens, earned a spot on the team by shooting 4-for-7 on 3s with 20 points and seven rebounds in the championship game.

Beloit West Branch 42, Hamilton Badin 39

Ton Arndt of Beloit West Branch was named Most Valuable Player of The Associated Press Division II all-tournament team after leading her team to the title.

Arndt led the Warriors with 18 points and 14 rebounds. She had 12 points and 12 rebounds in a 57-44 win over Thornville Sheridan in the semifinals.

Young, Ursuline 66, Oak Hill 52

Tyra Grant is always on the lookout for the ball when it's in Courtney Davidson's hands. She's learned that keeping an eye on her point guard means easy baskets.

Davidson scored 21 points and got her teammates point-blank shots with a deft array of passes, sending Youngstown Ursuline to the Division III state championship with a 66-52 win over Oak Hill on Saturday.

Grant, the main beneficiary of Davidson's eight assists, added 22 points and nine rebounds as the Irish won their first state title.

Minister 44, Mansfield St. Peter's 33

Robyn Hoying of Division IV state champion Minister earned Most Valuable Player honors on the small-school Associated Press all-tournament team.

Hoying had 10 points and nine rebounds in the semifinals, and followed that up with 16 points, nine rebounds and 8-for-8 free throw shooting in the title game.

Her teammate, Bridget Stonkosky, was named to the

Boys pairings and results

DIVISION I

Tol. St. John's (22-4) vs. Coles Brookhaven (25-2)
Can. McKinley (22-3) vs. Hamilton (23-2)

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

Can. McKinley 68, Colerwood 57
Coles Brookhaven 52, Can. Moeller 48
Hamilton 54, Spring S 45

Tot. St. John's 79, Olmsted Falls 62

DIVISION II

Canal Fulton NW (23-1) vs. Dayton Chaminade-Julienne (19-7)
Ottawa-Glandorf (25-1) vs. Dover (22-3)

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

Canal Fulton NW 52, Chesterland W. Geauga 42
Loudonville 54, Loudonville Aquinas 44
Dover 57, Beethroft 54
Ottawa-Glandorf 54, Akron SVSM 52

DIVISION III

Loudonville (22-2) vs. St. Henry (20-5)
Bellare (22-4) vs. Versailles (25-0)

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

Bellare 71, Chesapeake 68
Loudonville 54, Loudonville Aquinas 37
St. Henry 53, Covington Falls CVCA 36
Versailles 58, Reading 50

DIVISION IV

Marla Stein Marion Local (17-9) vs. Sebring McKinley (24-1)
S. Webster (22-3) vs. Holgate (18-7)

FRIDAY'S RESULTS

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Holgate 35, Ft. Jennings 33
Marla Stein Marion Local 54, Day Jefferson Twp. 45
S. Webster 55, Mansfield St. Peter's 61
Sebring McKinley 38, Kidron Cent. Christian 44

Girls results

DIVISION I CHAMPIONSHIP

Can. Mt. Note Dame 59, Dayton Chaminade-Julienne 44

DIVISION II CHAMPIONSHIP

Beloit W. Branch 42, Hamilton Badin 39

DIVISION III CHAMPIONSHIP

Youngstown Ursuline 68, Oak Hill 52

DIVISION IV CHAMPIONSHIP

Minister 44, Mansfield St. Peter's 33